

picosite



The user manual

Table of contents

picosite	1
The user manual	1
Picosite Documentation	3
Appendix A	5

Picosite Documentation

Introduction

Welcome Picosite, a *minimalist* static site generator based on [markdown](#) and [handlebars templates](#).

Installation

Picosite is distributed as a single, stand along executables for [Linux, MacOS and Windows](#) to make it easy to use on your local computer and CI/CD systems.

If you prefer, you can also make use of it from an installed Dart SDK using: `dart pub global activate picosite`

Usage

Picosite works by taking a set of markdown content files ("pages") in a given directory and transforming them into HTML and then inserting that HTML into a specified Mustache template. By default the markdown content files are expected to in a subdirectory of the site directory named `pages`.

The template applied to each page is specified in that markdown files YAML "frontmatter". Here is an example from Picosites own documentation index page (ie. the page you are reading now):

```
---
title: Picosite Documentation
template: standardpage
---
```

Introduction

The template file is expected to be named with a html extension (`standardpage.html`) and Picosite will look for it in the `templates` subdirectory of the site directory or the path specified with the `templates` command line argument (`-t`).

Picosite can be run with no arguments given. In that case it will use default values for all the file system paths it requires to find the input files and also where it will write the output.

Asset files such as css, js, images, etc that just need to be copied across to the output can be placed in the assets subdirectory of the site directory and all the contents of that directory will be recursively copied to the output directory each time picosite is run.

Markdown support

Apart from "regular" markdown, some "extensions" are supported:

- Tables markup
- Inline HTML
- ID's are added to header elements (H1, H2, etc)

Handlebars Templates

Picosite supports templates using [Handlebars](#). Any variables defined in the YAML front matter of a markdown file are then available for use in the template using ``{{ variablename }}`.

Likewise, include files placed in the includes folder can be used in templates using the Handlebars syntax of `{{> filename }}`.

Data file, builtin variables and Handlebars

In *future releases* Picosite will support providing user data to be referenced by Handlebars variables as well as providing builtin variables such as the current date, list of content files, etc.

Previewing output

Picosite can run in a preview mode, where it will serve the output folder via HTTP and watch for changes in the site directory and rebuild the output when it notices saved changes to files in the site directory.

Credits

HTML and CSS template for these docs courtesy of [Carlos Yllobre](#)

Appendix A

Some extra information to show how multiple pages can be used with picosite PDF support.